

the USSR's supremacy in space by being the first interplanetary explorers. As early as 1964, Korolev had drawn up detailed plans on how to make this dream a reality through the use of innovative spacecraft and a revolutionary life support system. Indeed, Korolev was far ahead of his time and some of his work is still valid and used today.

However, despite such internal bickering among the Soviets, they did manage some incredible feats in this time. Indeed, it could well be argued that apart from the 'Moon Race', the Soviets won every aspect of the Space Race, including the first Extra Vehicular Activity, the first lunar probe and more.

Korolev was still involved in different aspects of the space programme and after his successful Vostok missions, he started developing plans for the Soyuz spacecraft which would eventually carry Russian astronauts to the moon. However, Soyuz was a good three years away from being operational, and as a stop-gap appeasement, he modified the existing Vostok to form the new Voskhod spacecraft, which would be the first multi-person flight into space as well as the first time cosmonauts travelled without spacesuits.

Joint NASA-SSP Moon Project

After Kennedy had committed to the Apollo programme of putting a man on the moon, the estimated budgetary costs – along with the actual feasibility of the project within the given timeline – started weighing on his mind. The challenge wasn't just to get to the moon, it was also to get there before the Soviets, who had beaten the US at every part of the Space Race so far.

Kennedy and Khrushchev enjoyed a special relationship that premiers of the two countries hadn't had since before World War II. It wasn't that they were friends, but through repeated meetings and conversations, a trust had started to form, according to Khrushchev's son who would recount these events later.

At the 1963 United States General Assembly, Kennedy laid down an audacious proposal of a joint space programme between the USA and the USSR to send man to the moon:

"In a field where the United States and the Soviet Union have a special capacity – in the field of space – there is room for new cooperation, for further joint efforts in the regulation and exploration of space. I include among these possibilities a joint expedition to the moon. Space offers no problems of sovereignty; by resolution of this Assembly, the members of the United Nations have foresworn any claim to territorial rights in outer space or on celestial bodies, and declared that international law and the United